The Private Markets Forum

Capital Built The Industry. Infrastructure Will Define Its Next Era.

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Private Markets Has Entered Its Technology Era. The Challenge Is No Longer Building Individual Solutions — It Is Connecting Them For Scale.

The stack, as described in the room:

I

Base — not yet built

II

Semantic

III

Control

IV

Presentation

Private markets still lacks a trusted, common record of what is owned, by whom, on what terms, and what it is worth.

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Capital Built The Industry. Infrastructure Will Define Its Next Era.

As the industry scales across wealth, pensions, insurance, and institutional investors, competitive advantage is now determined less by access to capital or deal flow, and more by the quality of the infrastructure connecting products, data, operations, and distribution.

The inaugural Private Markets Technology Summit in London on June 25, 2026 brought together senior operators, allocators, and technology leaders to examine what that shift means in practice. Despite the breadth of topics — AI, reporting, fund administration, portfolio management, wealth distribution — the conclusions converged on a single point: the challenge is no longer building individual technology solutions. It is connecting them for scale.

Participants kept returning to one word: layer. The data layer. The semantic layer. The control layer. The presentation layer. Beneath each conversation sat the same unresolved issue: private markets still lacks a trusted, common record of what is owned, by whom, on what terms, and what it is worth.

That absence explains more than any single trend. It explains why AI struggles without a semantic foundation to reason against. Why PDFs remain the industry's default reporting format long after public markets moved to machine-readable data. Why the widely cited $10 trillion wealth opportunity keeps colliding with infrastructure built for large institutional investors.

And why standardization has turned out to be a governance problem wearing a technology costume?

Two forces are accelerating the need to resolve it. The first is AI: firms are discovering that competitive advantage no longer comes from model access, but from the institutional knowledge and governed data that make those models trustworthy. The second is distribution: wealth, pensions, and insurance are expanding the investor base faster than operating infrastructure can adapt.

The firms that define the next decade of private markets will not simply invest better. They will build better infrastructure.

WHY THIS MATTERS NOW

A Small Corner Of Financial Services, Asked To Behave Like A Mature One

For decades, the industry's growth was defined by capital formation: bigger funds, broader allocations, new products. Today, that equation is shifting. Capital continues to grow, but the industry's ability to scale increasingly depends on something less visible: the infrastructure connecting data, operations, technology, products, and investors.

Private markets is a relatively small corner of financial services being asked to deliver the accessibility, transparency, and operational sophistication of far more mature markets.

Force 1

AI

Reshaping origination, underwriting, portfolio monitoring, and operational work.

Force 2

Regulatory shifts

Policy change is opening new pathways for private market participation across regions.

Force 3

Demographic change

One of the largest intergenerational wealth transfers in history is expanding demand from wealth investors, while pensions and insurers keep raising private-asset exposure.

Force 4

Blurring boundaries

Software providers, data companies, fund administrators, custodians, transfer agents, and market infrastructure providers are each expanding beyond their historical roles.

Complexity Isn't Accumulating; It's Compounding

Near-term conditions remain tight: fundraising has slowed, exits are constrained across many strategies, and firms are operating in a more disciplined capital environment than a few years ago. But the conversation wasn't about whether private markets grows; it was about whether the industry can build the infrastructure before the next wave of growth arrives, rather than after, as has historically been the pattern.

Every new investor segment brings different expectations for reporting, servicing, liquidity, and compliance. Every new product adds operational workflows. Every new distribution channel adds systems, counterparties, and datasets that must work together.

The clearest takeaway from the day: private markets is not primarily constrained by investor demand; long-term capital appears set to keep expanding. The real question is whether the industry's operating infrastructure can keep pace.



Panel 5, Reporting: beyond the quarterly PDF

Credits: The Private Markets Forum Team



In discussion on stage at the inaugural Summit

Credits: The Private Markets Forum Team

The Base Layer

What is owned, by whom, on what terms — and what it is worth. The layer private markets has not built yet.

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01 Private Markets Doesn't Have A Base Layer Yet

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Private markets lacks the standardized instrument, issuer, and pricing infrastructure that took public markets decades to build. Risk is managed deal by deal through covenants rather than portfolio-level data models, making a consistent data schema difficult to apply at scale.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is the industry's primary scaling constraint. Every capability discussed at the Summit — AI, portfolio analytics, faster credit decisions, retail-ready reporting — depends on a trusted data foundation. Without it, firms risk automating fragmented processes rather than fixing the underlying problem.

What to consider

Before accelerating AI or automation initiatives, ask whether the underlying data foundation can actually support them. Firms treating data architecture and semantic models as foundational infrastructure, not as AI projects, are building the more durable advantage.

02 Reconciliation Is Mostly Noise, Not Signal

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Match rates in reconciliation vary widely across asset classes, largely because the industry lacks standardized security and entity identifiers. Operational teams spend much of their time chasing differences that stem from inconsistent data definitions and timing conventions, not genuine economic discrepancies.

WHY IT MATTERS

The real challenge isn't reconciliation; it's distinguishing meaningful exceptions from representational noise. As transaction volumes and reporting complexity grow, firms that can reliably identify what requires human attention will scale operations without scaling headcount at the same rate.

What to consider

The next competitive advantage may not come from automating reconciliation, but from building the intelligence layer that separates real risk from noise.

03 Fund Administration Is Becoming Strategic

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Fund administration has long been treated as a back-office cost center. Firms are rethinking that, recognizing that decades of outsourced processes have often separated data from the institutional context needed to interpret, trust, and automate it.

WHY IT MATTERS

As AI and self-service analytics spread, structured fund data is turning from an operational by-product into a strategic asset. Firms with trusted, accessible fund administration data will move faster on due diligence and investor servicing, and will be better positioned for automation.

What to consider

If fund administration data is now a strategic asset, is it managed like one? Its quality, accessibility, and ownership may matter as much as the efficiency of the service model itself.

The Semantic Layer

What the data means, and who agrees on it. Without shared meaning, AI infers — confidently, and sometimes wrongly.

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01 AI Needs A Semantic Layer To Be Trusted

WHAT'S HAPPENING

AI can only interpret data as well as the context it's given. Without a shared business glossary or semantic layer defining what data actually represents, AI agents are left inferring meaning from ambiguous fields — a recipe for confident, incorrect output.

WHY IT MATTERS

In private markets, a wrong AI output isn't just a productivity issue; it carries regulatory, fiduciary, and reputational risk. As firms move toward agentic AI, trust will depend less on model performance and more on the governance and consistency of the underlying data.

What to consider

Before expanding AI use cases, ask whether your organization has a common language for its data. AI maturity is a function of data maturity, not the other way around.

02 Institutional Memory Is Becoming The Real Moat

WHAT'S HAPPENING

As frontier models become commoditized, competitive advantage is shifting from model access to the proprietary knowledge firms bring to those models: investment theses, historical decisions, operating playbooks, institutional expertise.

WHY IT MATTERS

The most effective AI agents aren't deployed, they're trained — improving through feedback and accumulated organizational experience, much like a new employee. Firms that codify how decisions are made build capabilities that are difficult to replicate.

What to consider

Model access matters less than owning the knowledge that powers it. How is your organization capturing institutional expertise before it walks out the door, or stays locked in individual teams?

The Control Layer

What can be trusted enough to act on — and who has to agree before it can be standardized.

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01 AI Works Best As A Control Layer

WHAT'S HAPPENING

The most mature AI deployments in private markets aren't replacing people; they're strengthening existing controls. Rather than automating judgment calls, firms are using AI to validate NAV calculations, flag anomalies, and surface exceptions a human might otherwise miss.

WHY IT MATTERS

This approach addresses the biggest barrier to AI adoption: trust. Positioning AI as a final layer of quality assurance rather than an autonomous decision-maker lets firms demonstrate measurable value while keeping implementation risk low.

What to consider

Firms struggling to scale AI may do better starting with high-confidence control and exception-management use cases before expanding into more autonomous workflows.

02 Standardization Isn't (Just) A Technology Problem

WHAT'S HAPPENING

The technology to standardize private markets data largely exists already. The harder problem is aligning incentives across an ecosystem where every counterparty defines, structures, and exchanges information differently; even standardized templates get filled in inconsistently.

WHY IT MATTERS

History suggests shared infrastructure emerges from industry coordination as much as from technological innovation. Without stronger governance or regulatory momentum, universal standards will likely stay out of reach regardless of how good the technology gets.

What to consider

Rather than waiting for industry-wide standards, firms may get more near-term value from technology that translates between disparate data models, enabling interoperability without requiring everyone to adopt the same standard.

The Presentation Layer

What actually reaches the investor — and what breaks when the investor base changes shape.

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01 The PDF Isn't The Problem

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Private markets reporting follows a familiar pattern: information originates in a PDF, gets manually extracted into a system, and is reproduced in another PDF for the next participant in the value chain. The document itself is still valuable as a legal record and presentation layer; the inefficiency is treating it as the primary vehicle for structured data exchange.

WHY IT MATTERS

Swapping one document format for another doesn't fix anything. Unless structured data is created at the point of origination, firms will keep investing in better extraction rather than letting data flow directly between systems.

What to consider

The goal isn't eliminating PDFs; it's reducing dependence on them. Where can structured, system-to-system data exchange replace manual extraction while preserving the PDF for its intended purpose — the legal record, the client-facing document?

02 Public And Private Speak Different Risk Languages

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Many allocators still can't confidently answer three basic questions: What do I own? What is my true exposure? How would my portfolio behave under different market conditions? Public and private assets were built around different risk frameworks, which makes a unified portfolio view hard to produce with traditional analytics alone.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is an integration problem, not a data-availability one. As wealth platforms and DC pensions expand into private markets, demand for timely, portfolio-level risk visibility will only grow.

What to consider

Rather than forcing private assets into public-market frameworks, consider whether purpose-built analytics can give a more accurate view of total portfolio risk across both.

03 Wealth Will Test The Industry's Infrastructure

WHAT'S HAPPENING

Most of today's private markets infrastructure was built for institutional investors, high-value transactions, and low volumes. Wealth distribution introduces a fundamentally different operating model, one that places far greater demands on onboarding, subscription processing, liquidity management, and investor servicing.

WHY IT MATTERS

Recent redemption activity in semi-liquid funds showed how quickly operational strain surfaces when infrastructure is pushed beyond its original design. As wealth allocations grow, scalable operating infrastructure becomes a prerequisite for growth, not a supporting capability.

What to consider

Which parts of your operating model would break first if investor volumes grew by an order of magnitude?

IN PRACTICE

Three Things Leading Firms Are Doing Now

For decades, the industry's growth was defined by capital formation: bigger funds, broader allocations, new products. Today, that equation is shifting. Capital continues to grow, but the industry's ability to scale increasingly depends on something less visible: the infrastructure connecting data, operations, technology, products, and investors.

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01 Building The Semantic Layer Before The Agent Layer

Rather than deploying AI directly onto raw, unstructured data, leading firms are doing the less visible work first: business glossaries, ontologies, a golden source of truth. This includes feeding an AI system internal policies and decision-making frameworks before asking it to perform any actual task — treating institutional memory as infrastructure to be built deliberately, not a byproduct that accumulates on its own.

02 Redesigning Workflows End-To-End, Not Automating Them Piece By Piece

Drawing a parallel to early-industrial factories that saw no productivity gains from electrification until the factory floor was redesigned around it, leading GPs and LPs are moving past a “bolt AI onto the existing process” mindset. In practice: dedicated transformation sprints, structured change management — usage transparency, internal champions, recognition programs — and meeting users in the tools they already trust while re-engineering what happens behind those interfaces.

03

Treating Data And Reporting Infrastructure As A Competitive Asset, Not A Cost Center

In fund administration, LP reporting, and portfolio monitoring, the firms pulling ahead are reclaiming ownership of their data pipelines rather than treating them as outsourced and forgettable. That means insourcing or actively governing previously outsourced data relationships, investing in structured data capture at the point of origination, and treating data speed and quality as a direct input to fundraising, LP trust, and deal velocity — not just an efficiency metric.



Panellists in conversation at the inaugural Summit in London

Credits: The Private Markets Forum Team

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Private Markets Is Now Building Its Own Infrastructure Layer

The industry has the capital ambition, the investor appetite across wealth, pensions, insurance, and institutions, and, increasingly, the AI tooling. What it does not yet have, consistently, is the infrastructure: the shared data record, the semantic context, the standards — or the translation tools that substitute for them — and the operational rails to service structurally different investor types at once.

That infrastructure is what will determine whether this ambition can scale. Competitive advantage in the next phase will be won on the quality of the infrastructure connecting products, data, operations, and distribution.

That gap is not a reason for pessimism. Moments of market stress and structural growing pains have historically accelerated infrastructure build-out rather than delayed it. Public markets took decades, several crises, and coordinated industry action to build the rails now taken for granted. Private markets is earlier in that journey, but moving with the benefit of AI, cloud infrastructure, and a clearer sense of what good looks like, having watched public markets do it first.

The organizations in the room — allocators rethinking total portfolio approaches, GPs redesigning workflows from the ground up, and the technology and data providers building the layers beneath them — are doing that building work in real time. The Private Markets Forum was proud to convene this conversation in London for the first time, and looks forward to tracking this build-out as it accelerates.

The Private Markets Forum

With thanks to the summit's sponsors — Hebbia, MSCI, Canoe Intelligence, Auquan, Daphne, SimCorp, Fundguard, Indus Valley Partners, SS&C Intralinks, StructureFlow, 9Fin, Syntax, Affinity, Mantle, Chronograph and Loans Market Association — for supporting the summit and this ongoing conversation.

These insights synthesize patterns that recurred across the day's conversations rather than summarizing any single session. The Private Markets Technology Summit took place in London on 25 June 2026.